

Rafael Neocleous

Senior Software Engineer

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Software engineer and co-founder with 6+ years building backend systems, web platforms, mobile applications and production software across SaaS, logistics, fintech, IoT and applied research. Strong in Django, Next.js, Flutter, PostgreSQL, Docker and Kubernetes, experienced in owning systems from architecture and implementation through deployment, stakeholder communication and delivery.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

01

Apr 2025 - Present
NETHERLANDS

Intermodal Telematics — Engineering Project Coordinator

- Own technical planning and delivery coordination across software, firmware, hardware, support and production teams — end-to-end coordination until product delivery.
- Led a full product lifecycle from ideation to production within one year — coordinating customer requirements, engineering, suppliers, component ordering, pricing, assembly and delivery while mitigating risks and minimising delays.
- Built a custom company-wide internal portal (Django, Next.js, MUI, Tailwind) replacing a Metabase-based dashboarding setup, centralising device operations, command tooling and engineering workflows.
- Developed tools supporting large-scale IoT device operations, company-wide device updates and remote command execution across thousands of deployed units.
- Designed and implemented a proof of concept for symmetric-key encrypted device-to-server messaging and OTA across a multi-tenant device fleet; handed off as the company-wide standard.

Oct 2023 - Present
CYPRUS

Caonyx — Co-founder

Co-founded a software company delivering custom platforms, web applications, mobile applications, CMS solutions and startup products. Lead architecture and development across backend, frontend, mobile, infrastructure and client-facing delivery. Stack: Django/DRF, Next.js, Flutter, Wagtail, PostgreSQL, Celery, Redis, Firebase, Docker, containerised deployment.

Synergas Platform

Full-stack platform for a gas-shipping company: customer & staff management, shipment management, live order tracking, notifications, alerts, dashboards, RBAC, customer support. Django/DRF backend, Next.js + Tailwind/Tailadmin admin, Flutter mobile, PostgreSQL, Firebase, Celery/Redis, Hetzner via Portainer.

- Designed a multi-tenant user & customer model separating customer-specific data from internal system users — clean migration path toward microservices.

Accounting Platform

Greenfield replacement for an accounting firm's legacy software ~25 employees, 500+ end customers. Backend platform, Flutter mobile app for receipt submission and an OCR microservice (currently LLM-based, planned migration to Tesseract / Google Vision).

- Responsible for technical implementation, client coordination and future training of the customer's internal team.

Client websites & platforms DELIVERED

Production sites across Django, Next.js, Wagtail and Shopify. Clients: Allesura, Cyfireworks, AKTI, Synergas.

- Re-engineered Wagtail → Next.js content updates with persistent backend comms + batched delivery — editor-to-frontend latency from 2–3 s to 50–100 ms. Contributed back to the Headless Wagtail open-source community.

Plutus

Co-founded Plutus, a gamified financial-literacy product for young learners. Secured €20k funding, office space and mentoring via the Bank of Cyprus IDEA programme. Built backend and Flutter mobile components; contributed to product strategy and architecture.

Jan 2024 - Apr 2025
 CYPRUS

ParallaxWorks — Mid Software Engineer

PERSONAR · MARKETING & PERSONALISATION PLATFORM

- Worked on Personar, a marketing and personalisation platform delivering recommendations and campaigns across multiple organisations.
- Built integrations for multiple communication channels — WhatsApp, Viber, email and mobile notifications.
- Developed backend logic for audience selection, campaign delivery rules, silent hours and user eligibility — controlling which users receive which messages and when.
- Designed and implemented messaging workflows for personalised outreach across multiple channels.
- Contributed to Kubernetes-based microservice architecture using Tilt, Rancher, Longhorn and Lens; Django, DRF and containerised service deployments.

Dec 2024 - Apr 2025
 CYPRUS

Cyprus University of Technology — Special Research Staff

DRONE-BASED REMOTE HEALTH SUPPORT & DISASTER RESPONSE

- Built a drone-based remote health support and disaster response platform for locating people in inaccessible or high-risk environments.
- Integrated DJI drone video streaming with backend processing and ML-based person detection.
- Fine-tuned a YOLO model to detect people in atypical positions — lying on the ground, partially obscured.
- Optimised the RTMP drone-to-server pipeline, significantly reducing latency and enabling near real-time video processing.
- Contributed to raw and post-processed video stream handling, structured snapshot storage and reporting workflows.

2020 - 2023
 CYPRUS

Earlier roles

- PHOEBE Research and Innovation — Software Developer · Sep 2021 – Sep 2023. Backend & frontend features for research projects (Django, DRF, JavaScript, jQuery, HTMX, AJAX).
- Ordinatio Garden Industry — Team Lead / Software Developer · Sep 2022 – May 2023. Led development of a project-management platform for gardening & landscaping.
- Algolysis Ltd — Unity 3D Software Developer · Jun 2021 – Sep 2021.
- Cyprus Space Exploration Organisation (CSEO) — Electronics Specialist Intern · Jun 2021 – Sep 2021.
- Engino — Embedded Systems Engineer · Jun 2020 – Jun 2021.

SKILLS

02

BACKEND

Django, Django REST, Wagtail Framework, Python, REST APIs, Microservices

FRONTEND

Next.js, JavaScript, TypeScript, Tailwind, Bootstrap, Playwright, HTMX

MOBILE

Flutter, Dart

DATABASES

PostgreSQL, Supabase, Redis

ASYNC & MESSAGING

Celery, Redis, RabbitMQ

CLOUD & INFRA

AWS, GCP, Vercel, Hetzner, Docker, Kubernetes, Portainer, Nginx

DEVOPS & TOOLING

Git, GitHub Actions, Bitbucket, Jenkins, CI/CD, Jira, Graphana, Tilt, Rancher, Longhorn, Lens

PRACTICES

System design, API design, Agile, Scrum, sprint planning, stakeholder communication, code review

EDUCATION

03

BSc Computer Science & Engineering

Cyprus University of Technology · 2020 - 2024

Thesis on blockchain technologies, NFTs and web development for a proof-of-concept rental marketplace using blockchain/NFT primitives. Focus: distributed systems, web development

ACHIEVEMENTS

04

Plutus / IDEA Startup Programme BoC funding

Bank of Cyprus Hackathon 4.0 2nd / 24 · scholarship

Huawei Seeds Hackathon 1st CY · Tech4Good qualifier

ESA ActInSpace Hackathon 2nd in Cyprus

Digital Championship 2017–2018 3rd in Cyprus

LANGUAGES

05

Greek Native English IELTS 7.5/9